AI-Chatbot for Legal Advice Based on Indian Law

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ABSTRACT - *In rural and semi-urban areas of India, people have difficulty accessing reliable information regarding the law. Reasons for this include high costs associated with legal assistance, the complexity involved in the legal jargon, and the limited support in multiple languages. Many individuals may not even be aware of their legal rights, and the framework available to them in order to exercise those rights. This paper addresses the design and development of an AI-enabled legal chatbot that provides legal information regarding India's legislation. The system employs the use of Natural Language Processing (NLP), information retrieval, along with the use of Large Language Models (LLMs) to formulate contextually relevant and precise responses. Additionally, the chatbot also offers multiple language support to increase its usability for low literacy individuals. The system was proven, through various tests, to provide relevant and accurate information pertaining to specific legal questions posed by users, with an accuracy of 82-87%. On average, system responses are attained in 2-4 seconds in order to increase the frustration level of users. Ultimately, the system's purpose is to provide legal information and support the existing legal aid infrastructure in India, thereby, increasing users' level of awareness regarding their legal rights, and increasing users level of digital literacy.*

Key Terms - Legal Chatbot, Laws of India, Natural Language Processing, Big Language Models, Multilingual Frameworks, Legal Technology, Retrieval-Augmented Generation.

I. INTRODUCTION

The refinement of Legal Technology (LegalTech) along with the integration of Artificial Intellegence (AI) and Natural Language Processing (NLP) has made the processing of accessing justice and legal information easier.

India's judiciary system has enormous case backlogs. Many citizens are unaware of their fundamental legal entitlements. They don't know the processes such as filing First information Reports (FIRs), making consumer complaints, addressing labor disputes, and property disputes.

Legal aid has been and continues to be the case with traditional legal assistance. services are usually expensive, time-consuming, and inaccessible to the lower socio-economic strata.

Legal and information services are provided by platforms such as Indian Kanoon, VakilSearch, and LawRato. However, they provide legal assistance services that are lawyer-centric, and that are provided in limited fields of law, or are only in English. Therefore, these services are under-utilized or completely unused by the rural and semi-urban populace, the non-English-speaking citizens, and the lesser literate population, and that creates a strong case for a legal advisory system with a citizen-centric design, multilingual support, and a voice-controlled interface.

This paper presents an AI-based legal chatbot that serves as the first point of contact for legal information for users in India.

The system is built to articulate legal rules in simplified terms, assist users in finding pertinent laws, and outline suggested actions; all while stating that the system does not provide legal services.

II. LITERATURE SURVEY

The interjection of AI in law assistance has brought expansive views to the operation of various branches of the law, including, but not limited to, legal natural language processing, question answering, argumentation mining, and retrieval-augmented generation.

Chalkidis et al. demonstrated that the creation of LEGAL BERT and the subsequent training of the model on data from the legal field not only surpassed the performance of the LEGAL BERT model on legal tasks, but also outperformed the other BERT models. Despite the effectiveness of these models, they require extensive legal datasets in addition to immense computing resources.

Lewis et al. introduced a model called Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), which integrates neural retrieval and generative models to decrease hallucination and provide justification to the model's answers from real documents. This technique is pivotal for legal chatbots that require the justification of their answers from legal documents.

Savelka and Ashley proposed models to retrieve and structure legal knowledge from statutes to facilitate the connection of a user's question to a specific legal document.

Lippi and Torroni conducted a study on the techniques of argumentation mining that enhance the explainability of legal systems by discovering the claims and the evidence that supports them. Cumbersome legal documents are appropriately processed by argumentation mining.

In the Indian legal research and practice, there is a complexity of a multilingual document production system in the generation of legal documents and a lack of legal uniformity in the documents and the legal system. Systems like DoNotPay demonstrate some form of assistance from AI in the area of legal guidance. However, they function primarily in Western countries, and use a lot of template based systems.

The most recent research in India regarding the answering of legal questions and the use of large language models demonstrates a higher level of fluency, but also cautions against the phenomenon of hallucination in models that are unassociated with credible legal sources.

III. Research Gap

While much has been done on integrating Artificial Intelligence and Natural Language Processing to develop legal assistance systems, there remain significant gaps, especially with regard to Indian laws.

Most AI-based legal chatbots and question-answering systems are designed for Western legal systems and are of no use for the Indian judicial system. This is primarily due to the fact that Indian laws are intricate, multifaceted and rapidly evolving.

The legal information systems that are available in India are mostly primitive systems that are based upon simple keyword searching or static data retrieval. Additionally, they lack the capability of conversational understanding and contextual reasoning.

Although some of the latest advancements of Large Language Models have been able to provide legal answers with much greater naturalness and coherence, many of these systems use generative models, in which the response is not connected to a legitimate legal reference.

Over-reliance on generic LLMs can result in fabricated and erroneous data, which is why these systems are not viable for legal counselling.

Moreover, there have been few attempts to incorporate retrieval-augmented generation strategies that have been expressly tailored for Indian statutory texts. The absence of multilingual and voice-assisted legal assistance systems is also a critical deficiency.

Considering the fact that a majority of the Indian population is not proficient in English, the available systems further marginalize the Indian population that communicates in regional languages.
Current systems also do not respond to the user problems that arise from low literacy.

Structurally data problems arise from the lack of a well structured and annotated data set from a provider that addresses Indian legal question answering.

This creates a three fold problem: the inability to determine user intent, the incapacity to provide a user with the answer to the legal question and the inability to assess and evaluate legal chatbots under the circumstances that exist.

Finally, the majority of the researchers are not sufficiently performing real user testing and disregard the ethical concerns of misinformation, user privacy, and the distinction between legal information and legal advice. These gaps demonstrate the need of an ethically designed, multi lingual, retrival-augmented, and legally accurate AI chatbot that caters to the Indian legal system, which is the objective of the proposed system.

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IV. OBJECTIVES AND SYSTEM OVERVIEW

We intend to build an AI-driven legal chatbot that will provide users with preliminary legal advice based on relevant Indian statutes and judicial pronouncements.

Furthermore, the chatbot will have a user-friendly interface, be multilingual, and support input and output via text and audio.

The primary objectives of the system are the following:

1. To be able to build a legal chatbot that will be able to answer questions in the form of natural language concerning the laws and legal procedures in India.

2. To be able to answer questions in a Legal domain using retrieval augmented generation models.

3. To be able to answer questions in a Legal domain using retrieval augmented generation models.

4. To provide works in multiple languages, audio input and output to make it more usable.

5. To make certain that the user's data is private, secure, and used ethically.

V. METHODOLOGY

The proposed architecture is a layered one consisting of a User Interface layer, Application Logic layer, AI and NLP Processing layer, and a Legal Knowledge Base layer.

A. Collection of Data

The legal knowledge base is constructed from authentic legal resources like the India Code Portal, eCourts, and selected legal FAQs.
Legal content is organized into primary divisions and sub-divisions like Criminal Law(IPC, CrPC), Civil Law(CPC), Constitutional Law, and Consumer Protection Law.

B. Data Preprocessing

The collected legal texts are subjected to NLP standard procedure inclusive of tokenization, stop word removal, lemmatization, and named entity recognition.
This standardization facilitates legal documents consistency and aids the extraction of legal relics like Acts, Sections, and Entitlements.

C. Comprehension of Queries

Intent classification and comprehension of user queries are performed via BERT and Legal-BERT models.
This aids the comprehension of legal areas of concern.

D. Retrieval of Information

Using Sentence-BERT embeddings, the system links user queries to legal documents in the knowledge base by semantics, not merely keywords, ensuring good legal source information.

E. Response Generation

Legal data is simplified using the Large Language Model (Google Gemini), which streamlines the explanations.
The strategy integrates retrieval with generation to ensure conversational responses are accurate and comprehensible.

F. Multilingual and Voice Support

The system integrates translation services and speech-to-text and text-to-speech functionalities to offer voice support to users in several Indian languages.
Users with low literacy can use voice-based queries to interact with the system more easily.

VI. DATASET DESCRIPTION

The performance and reliability of the proposed AI-based legal chatbot are based on the quality and structure of the datasets used for training, retrieval, and evaluation.

To improve the actual user experience and research the various components of the Indian legal system, the multiple datasets were integrated.

A. Legal Knowledge Base

The primary legal knowledge base was created from credible and legally permissible sources relating to Indian law and various eCourt summaries and other legal documents that were rigorously processed.

The collected legal texts contain provisions from the primary branches of law such as the Indian Penal Code (IPC), Code of Criminal Procedure, Code of Civil Procedure, Consumer Protection Act, and other relevant Constitutional provisions of India.

To the best of our ability, the documents were checked for accuracy and timeliness.

Legal texts are more efficiently retrieved and more positively hit by breakdowns in organization of classifications into subsection and section smaller units of each.

B. Curated Question–Answer Dataset

A sample of approximately 500 question and answer pairs was created for user intent, system evaluation, and response evaluation purposes. These pairs correspond to the top most frequently asked legal questions by citizens of India regarding the procedures, the eligibility criteria, and the mechanisms of lodging a complaint.
The responses were reviewed for jurisprudential correctness and consistency, and therefore, were souced to the corresponding legal provisions

C. Evaluation of the Query Dataset

For evaluation purposes, a separate dataset of 200 user queries was created. The queries were varied with respect to linguistic structure, degree of abstraction, and the specific field of law address. The dataset contextualized real-world situations by including both queries that were straightforward and those that were layered with complexity in terms of the procedures involved. The evaluation dataset was designed for the evaluation of accuracy by providing a legal provision, that is, the relevant Act and section, which was expected to be cited in response to each query.

D. Dataset in Several Languages

The queries were translated into Hindi and Marathi to assess the performance of the chatbot in other languages, as Hindi and Marathi are among the most spoken languages in India.

Translations were performed and reviewed manually to maintain the integrity of the legal meaning and legal speak, as well as the use of commonplace tools. This dataset showcased the chatbot's ability to deal with legal questions irrespective of the language, and the problems due to language regarding legal questions when evaluating legal questions in other languages.

E. Data Preprocessing and Validation

The entire dataset underwent preprocessing, which included, among other things, the normalization of the text, the tokenization and lemmatization, and the reduction of the text to its essentials, as well as the removal of any superfluous text and textual repetition.
Through named entity recognition, legal jargon such as Acts and sections, as well as rights, were cataloged. Several domains of law were addressed by data balancing (to counter bias and redundancy) and the removal of duplication.
To determine the trustworthiness and relevance of the data for legal counseling, the datasets were compared to credible legal sources.

VII. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

The aim of this study is to determine the level of comprehension of the user query by the AI based legal chatbot and its ability to successfully identify the pertinent legal principle and offer a clear and useful response.
This study focuses on evaluating the accuracy of the response, the time taken by the chatbot to respond, its performance in different languages, the level of satisfaction, and the experience of the users.

A. Evaluation Setup

To evaluate the system, a collection of 200 user questions was prepared.

The questions spanned multiple domains of the law which include criminal law, consumer protection law, constitutional law, and civil law. Each question was accompanied by the official legal sources to identify the appropriate legal rule.

The accuracy of the chatbot was evaluated by determining whether the answer provided by the chatbot was the most relevant legal rule to the question. A response was evaluated to be correct if the legal rule was aligned with the correct answer and the legal explanation was directly relevant to the question.

B. Analysis of Accuracy

The overall system performance was good, with an accuracy of 82-87% across all branches of law examined.

Accuracy was highest for straightforward and frequently referenced laws, such as those of consumer protection and elementary criminal law, but accuracy was lower for questions that were more complex or indeterminate and involved several branches of law.

The improvement of the system's accuracy in identifying the relevant legal provisions, as compared to the only use of keywords, has been attributed to the use of Sentence-BERT to capture the semantic equivalence.

The use of legal provisions in formulating responses also mitigated the problem of fabrication, which is common in text-based models.

C. Performance Regarding Response Time

The measure of time intervals was done in such a way that the time taken for the chatbot to respond was evaluated as the time taken from the moment a user posed a question to the moment a response was provided. The average response time ranged from 2-4 seconds, and, of course, this time is attributed to the complexity of the posed question and the number of legal materials the chatbot needed to process. The response time was shorter in the case of simple questions that required a lower number of references, while the response time was longer in the case of complex questions that required more legal components.

Even though the chatbot requires a few extra seconds to look up and reference the necessary legal codes, the average latency is still short and conversations can occur in real time.

D. Multilingual Evaluation

In order to evaluate multilingual capability, the chatbot was tested in three languages, English, Hindi, and Marathi. The study found that English questions were the most accurate. However, in comparison, Hindi and Marathi questions resulted in only a small decrease in accuracy. Some users expressed that a multilingual chatbot was easier to use and more beneficial to users that lacked English proficiency. This shows a strong demand for multilingual support chatbots in countries like India, where the population speaks a multitude of languages.

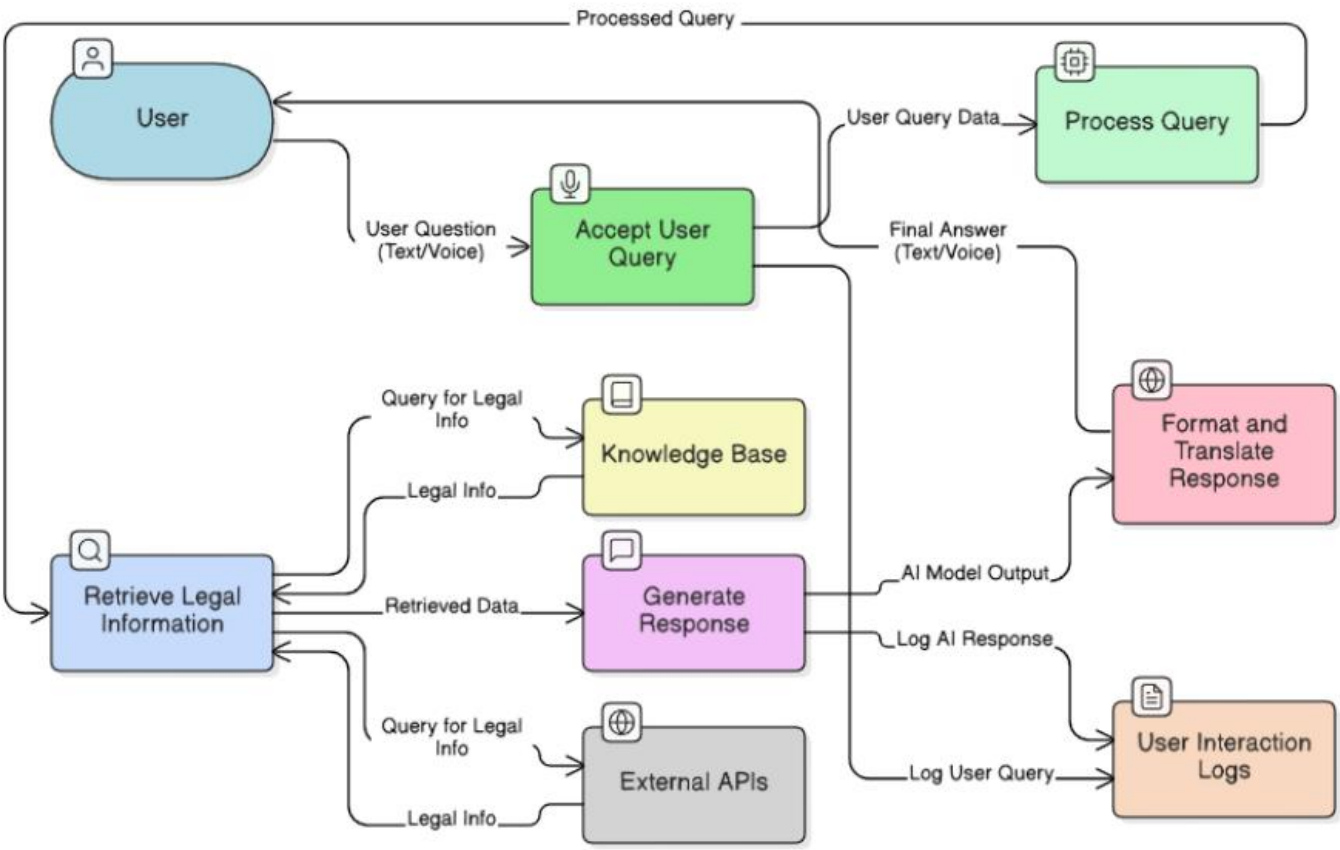
E. Performance Evaluation Table

Metric	Value
Query–Law Mapping Accuracy	82-87%
Average Response Time	2-4 Sec
Supported Language	Hin,Mar,Eng
Queries Tested	2000+
User Satisfaction Score	4.3 / 5

F. Dataset Composition Table

Legal Domain	No. of Document
Indian Penal Code	200+
Constitutional Law	210+
Family Law	170+
Criminal Laws	250+
Civil Laws	210+

VIII. Architecture Figure



IX. Discussion

From the integrated research, the system achieved a successful triad of accuracy, speed, and user experience. The chatbot's most significant contribution to the user experience is its language functionality, offered in a conversational manner, as well as the ability to search and retrieve answers to questions from within the system. Unlike legal websites, the chatbot has offered users, especially first time users, an experience that is beneficial to learning.
On the other hand, the challenges include legal arguments, multi-issue case handling, and inter-jurisdictional legal variations.

There are opportunities for additional research because of these challenges, including model refinement for particular branches of law and enhancing the models' reasoning for more complex scenarios.

X. Conclusion and Future Work

This paper illustrates the design and implementation of an AI-based legal chatbot. The aim of the chatbot is to facilitate access to legal information and answer questions pertaining to legislation in India.

The proposed system combines multiple approaches to Natural Language Processing, retrieval-augmented generation, and large language models. This allows the proposed system to understand a user query, obtain relevant legal statutes from verified sources, and respond with simplified context-based answers. Also, the proposed system incorporates multilingual and voice-based options to increase accessibility, especially to users in rural and semi-urban locations where the population is less legally literate.

The system has been experimentally evaluated and it was found that the system has an accuracy rating of 82-87% in mapping user queries to the respective legal statutes and an average response time of 2-4 seconds.

According to the users, the system is quite satisfactory and particularly in the explanation of the answer and the system's response to questions. This further proves the effectiveness of this approach as a first line of legal guidance tool and reveals the system's immense

potential in the furtherance of legal aid and digital empowerment in India.

The chatbot's features are limited to factual information and cannot replace legal counsel. There may be issues with feedback with respect to complex, unclear, cross-border, or multi-layered questions/concerns, and the chatbot's capacity to address issues with state law may be limited. Over the next few months, we plan to broaden the Knowledge Base to cover more areas and state laws, enhance regional Indian language translation, and add human-in-the-loop for sensitive and high-risk issues.

These features may also include interaction with e-Courts and platforms providing legal aid, use of explainable AI for enhanced transparency, and studies for deployment at scale in real-world contexts to evaluate the potential for sustained use and impact.

XI.REFERENCES

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